

250 Rupees Venture



...er writer and joint bookrunner



GROCERY DELIVERY SERVICE

By-Yash Goel

1. Venture Idea

The venture idea revolves around delivering groceries and essential items from a local Kirana store to elderly residents in my society. This service targets older individuals who are not familiar with or do not use modern delivery apps like Zepto or Blinkit. By offering a simple, personalized, and community-focused service, the goal was to address the inconvenience faced by these individuals while creating a positive societal impact.

2. Planning Phase

To ensure the venture's success within the constraints of a ₹250 budget and a 30-minute operational window, the following steps were undertaken:

a. *Idea Validation:*

- Observed the daily routines of elderly residents and identified their difficulty in accessing groceries.
- Confirmed the lack of delivery service by the local Kirana store.

b. *Resource Planning:*

- Budget Allocation: Allocated ₹250 for logistics (bags, communication costs, etc.).
- No-Capital Model: Orders and payments were collected in advance, eliminating the need for upfront investment in goods.

c. *Marketing and Order Collection:*

- Created a WhatsApp group specifically for elderly residents in the society.
- Shared a brief message explaining the service, operating window, and process for placing orders.
- Highlighted the service's benefits: convenience and personalized support.

d. *Operational Planning:*

- Set up a structured process to handle a maximum of 30-50 orders within the 30-minute slot.
- Pre-negotiated with the Kirana store for priority service.
- Designed a delivery route to optimize time and effort.
- Decided to charge a nominal handling fee of ₹20 per order to cover costs and generate revenue.

3. Execution Phase

a. *Pre-Delivery Activities:*

- Orders were collected a day before the operational slot to ensure smooth execution.
- Payments were received online, avoiding cash transactions and saving time during delivery.

b. *Execution on Delivery Day:*

- Arrived at the Kirana store 10 minutes prior to the delivery slot.
- Verified and packed items based on pre-received orders.
- Delivered items using a two-wheeler in a pre-planned sequence.
- Delivered 38 orders within the 30-minute time frame.

c. *Challenges Faced:*

- Coordinating with the store for timely item preparation.
- Managing traffic delays and ensuring timely delivery.
- Ensuring accurate order fulfilment.

4. Business Metrics

a. *Investment:*

- Total spent: ₹250 (bags: ₹200, mobile data: ₹50).

b. *Revenue:*

- Handling fee (₹20 per order): 38 orders x ₹20 = ₹760.

c. *Profit:*

- Revenue (₹760) - Investment (₹250) = ₹510.

d. *Key Activities:*

- Order collection and payment coordination.
- Grocery pickup and packing.
- Delivery execution.

5. Reflection and Learnings

a. *Observations on Business Process:*

- Effective communication via WhatsApp was instrumental in gathering orders efficiently.
- Pre-collection of payments ensured seamless transactions and eliminated financial risk.
- A structured delivery route reduced operational inefficiencies.

b. *Insights on Revenue and Profit:*

- The handling fee added a reasonable revenue stream while remaining affordable to customers.
- Maintaining low overhead costs ensured profitability.

c. *Takeaways:*

- Understanding customer needs is critical for creating impactful solutions.
- Leveraging existing tools like WhatsApp can save costs and improve outreach.
- Streamlined planning ensures successful execution within tight time frames.

d. *Future Improvements:*

- Explore expanding the delivery window to serve more customers.
- Introduce feedback mechanisms to enhance service quality.
- Collaborate with the Kirana store for bulk discounts or commissions.

6. Conclusion

This venture successfully addressed a real societal need by providing a convenient and affordable grocery delivery service to elderly residents. The experience offered valuable insights into planning, executing, and reflecting on a small-scale business venture. It demonstrated the potential for creating a positive social impact while maintaining financial sustainability.